

CASE STUDY: CYBERBULLYING – THE MEGAN MEIER INCIDENT

Cyberbullying is a type of online harassment in which people use digital media, like social media, instant messaging, or online forums, to insult, threaten, or humiliate other people. Unlike traditional bullying, cyberbullying can take place at any time and can be very harmful because it can easily spread. It is also difficult to avoid, unlike traditional bullying.

A real-life example of cyberbullying is the story of Megan Meier, who was bullied in the United States in 2006. She was a girl of 13 years of age. A person, who was actually an adult but posed as a teenage boy, created a false account on social media. The person sent friendly messages to Meier, and because of these friendly messages, Meier started trusting him. Gradually, however, the nature of their communication changed, and Meier received insulting messages from him. Later, Meier received a message from him saying, “The world would be better without you.”

The usual process of cyberbullying involves a bully choosing a vulnerable target and establishing contact with them under a fake profile. Then, they start to bully and harass them by sending threatening messages and spreading rumors. At times, they even share personal details with others to maximize the humiliation. Teenagers and young adults are the main targets of cyberbullying.

The impacts of cyberbullying on an individual are severe. It may cause psychological disorders like anxiety, depression, and reduced self-confidence. It may even lead to self-harm in extreme cases. This case emphasizes the need for digital awareness and behavior to ensure safety.